Beyond Data: AI for Human Connection

SYNC

AI:101

Prompt Engineering, Use Cases & Data Safety – A practitioner’s guide to working smarter with AI

What Is AI?

Prompt Engineering

Data Safety

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StratusLIVE

Speaker

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Agenda

- Welcome & Opening Discussion
- What Is AI? — Plain English
- Prompt Engineering Deep-Dive
- Live Demo!
- Real-World Use Cases
- Data Safety: What NOT to Share
- Key Takeaways & Q&A

What is AI?

No jargon. No computer science degree required.

Think of AI like a very well-read intern

Has read millions of documents.
Spots patterns incredibly fast.
Needs clear instructions from you.
Can be confidently wrong.
Gets better the more you guide it.

Not magic

AI is a statistical pattern-matcher trained on text. It predicts the most likely next word.

Not omniscient

It has a knowledge cutoff and can hallucinate facts. Always verify important outputs.

A tool — not a replacement

The people who use AI well will outpace those who don't. Your judgment still matters.

Over 100 million people use ChatGPT each week — AI is mainstream.

Prompt Engineering: The CRAFT Framework

How to talk to AI so it actually helps you

C — **Context**
Set the scene. “I’m a resource development officer at a non-profit…”

R — **Role**
Assign a persona. “Act as a grant writer for a federal government audience…”

A — **Action**
Use a precise verb. “Write/Summarize/Compare/Critique/Draft…”

F — **Format**
Specify Output. “Give me 5 bullet points.” “Write a 200-word email.”

T — **Tone**
Set the mood. “Professional but warm.” “Simple enough for a 5th grader.”

“R” for Refine – It is okay to ask AI to refine a response without putting in the same input.

Prompt Makeover: See the Difference

Same request – very different results

WEAK PROMPT

"Write me an email about the Janson Grant."

- No context about who is reading it
- No mention of purpose or urgency
- No tone or length guidance
- Result: Generic, bland output

STRONG PROMPT

"You're a senior grant writer. Write a 150-word grant status email to our VP updating them that the Janson proposal is complete and a decision within 2 weeks. Tone: Confident and concise."

- Sets a clear role
- Define the audience and purpose
- Specifies length
- Sets Tone

Let's Try It !

LIVE EXAMPLES

Real-World Use Cases

Where AI saves the most time — right now

Writing & Drafts

Emails, reports, proposals, job descriptions, meeting agendas — first draft in seconds.

Research & Summary

Paste a long document and ask for a 5-bullet summary. Instant briefing on any topic.

Brainstorming

Generate 10 campaign ideas, name options, or solutions to a problem before your next meeting.

Data & Analysis

Describe a dataset and ask AI to identify trends, suggest visuals, or draft the narrative.

Training & Onboarding

Create FAQs, onboarding scripts, quiz questions, or learning summaries instantly.

Customer Comms

Draft replies to common questions, create response templates, or tone-check messages.

Data Safety: What NOT to Share

Protecting yourself and your organization

NEVER SHARE

- Passwords, API keys, credentials
- Customer PII (names, emails, SSNs)
- Confidential contracts or financials
- Unreleased product or strategy details
- Employee personal information
- Health or medical records

BEST PRACTICES

- Anonymize data before pasting it in
- Use your company's approved AI tools only
- Check if prompts are used for model training
- Treat AI like a public forum — assume visible
- Always verify AI outputs before sending
- Follow your org's AI use policy

Golden Rule: If you wouldn't post it on LinkedIn, don't paste it into an AI tool.

Key Takeaways

Your 3 things to remember from today

1

Your prompt quality = your output quality

Vague in, vague out. Use CRAFT: Context, Role, Action, Format, Tone. Refine, don't retry.

2

AI is a multiplier — not a replacement

Start with low-stakes tasks: drafting, summarizing, brainstorming. Build confidence first.

3

Protect your data — every time

Anonymize before you paste. Know your org's policy. Treat AI like a public workspace.

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CRAFT Framework Access

Q&A